RAMYA YERRAMILLI

Product Strategy & Operations | Research-Led Product Discovery | Responsible AI

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SUMMARY

Product strategy and operations professional with an MS in Human-Computer Interaction (DePaul University), 6+ years of professional design, project and client-delivery experience, and 2+ years of mixed-methods research across B2B and B2C settings. Turns complex user and operational problems into prioritized requirements, workflow improvements and product decisions in financial services, higher-education operations, healthcare technology and responsible AI. Replaced a manual B2B reporting process with a live Power BI dashboard (about 3 hours saved per Portfolio Manager per week), cut counselor follow-ups by 20% and raised admissions throughput by 30%+, and won first place at a hackathon for an AI-assisted medication-management concept.

CORE SKILLS

Product & Strategy: Product Discovery, Product Requirements, Opportunity Identification, Prioritization, Cross-Functional Execution, Stakeholder Communication, Executive Presentations, Written Communication

Operations & Analysis: Workflow Improvement, Process Improvement, Root Cause Analysis, Data Analysis, Dashboards, Data Visualization, Project Coordination, Timelines and Deliverables, Documentation, Power BI, DAX, Tableau, Excel, Microsoft Office 365

Research & Insight: User Interviews, Surveys, Usability Testing, A/B Testing, Focus Groups, Mixed-Methods Research, Generative and Evaluative Research, Research Synthesis, Heuristic Evaluation, Qualtrics, Dovetail, Maze

Design & Prototyping: Information Architecture, Interaction Design, User Flows, Wireframing, Prototyping, Design Systems, Accessibility, Figma, Figma Make, Framer, UX Pilot, Axure, Adobe Creative Cloud

AI & Emerging Technology: Responsible AI, Human-AI Interaction, AI Evaluation, Prompt and Conversation Design, Dark Patterns, Healthcare Technology, Financial Services, Claude Code, Cursor, ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Copilot, Perplexity, NotebookLM, HTML/CSS, Vercel, Notion, Miro

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

UX Designer, Data Visualization (Internship) Jul 2025 - Sep 2025

MainStreet Advisors, a Fifth Third Bank Subsidiary | Chicago, IL

- Replaced a manual weekly reporting process (spreadsheets, CRM exports, email and hand calculations) with a live Power BI dashboard for Portfolio Managers covering $1.2B+ in assets; saved about 3 hours per Portfolio Manager per week, with the portfolio view available in under 10 seconds.
- Defined metrics, information hierarchy and personalized views from interviews with Portfolio Managers, analysts and operations; cleaned and modeled Excel and CRM data in Power BI (DAX) with two engineers.
- Delivered 5+ recommendations adopted by Product, Engineering and Design. Completed 100+ design iterations and shortened the release timeline by 2 sprints by bringing research and interaction design into product planning while requirements were still flexible.

Design Researcher Jun 2025 - Jun 2026

International Admissions, DePaul University | Chicago, IL

- Redesigned how incoming requests were categorized, prioritized and assigned, reducing counselor follow-up volume by 20% and increasing operational throughput by 30%+.
- Analyzed 1,000+ application records across 50+ markets to identify recurring workflow patterns and requirements affecting admissions review.
- Combined system data, workflow observation and AI-assisted analysis to identify operational improvements and clarify ownership across internal workflows.

UX Researcher (Graduate Researcher) Sep 2025 - Oct 2026

RAISE Lab, DePaul University | Chicago, IL

- Leading a team of five with two faculty advisors on a study of how generative AI systems use dark patterns, AI persona manipulation and anthropomorphism cues to erode user agency, with attention to vulnerable populations (in data collection, targeting CHI 2027).
- Translating qualitative observations of AI behavior into structured research questions, evaluation criteria and design implications for responsible, human-centered AI.
- Recognized with the Director's Award for Outstanding Researcher and the Authorship Contribution Award.

Senior Designer Jan 2023 - Jul 2024

Aedium Design, Hyderabad, India

- Sustained 9/10 client NPS across B2B engagements by owning projects from discovery and requirements definition through design delivery and implementation.

Senior Design Consultant
HomeLane, Hyderabad, India

- Reduced design-to-build latency by 15% across 10+ concurrent projects by translating customer requirements into structured specifications and resolving constraints before execution.

Design Consultant Jul 2019 - Jun 2021
TheM Design Studios, Hyderabad, India

- Delivered 15+ end-to-end B2C projects, managing customer requirements, design development, documentation and execution coordination.

PROJECT & RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

UX Designer & Project Manager, ASAP (AI-Scaffolded Action Planner) Jan 2026 - Jun 2026
Capstone Project, DePaul University | Chicago, IL

- Defined the interaction model and product requirements for an AI task-planning product that turns ambiguous goals into actionable workflows; research reframed the product from generating a plan to guiding the user's decisions.
- Used interviews, focus groups, usability testing, A/B testing and 12 AI-assisted interviews to identify friction, validated across 4 usability scenarios and 3 iterations; delivered a deployed prototype (Figma Make, Cursor, Claude Code, Vercel) on a four-person team.

Research Lead & UX Designer, RAAHI (Dark Pattern Detection) Mar 2025 - Sep 2026
DePaul University | Chicago, IL

- Set the product's scope and direction from 12 practitioner interviews and a 57+ response survey: a browser plugin instead of a standalone app, a three-tier shared taxonomy, and a flag-to-evidence workflow; worked with design, engineering, legal and data science.
- Created a 16-category evaluation framework across ChatGPT, Claude and Gemini, translating observed behaviors into product and evaluation requirements, and built a working prototype to test how users identify and review flagged patterns.

UX Designer, MeDementia (Miro x Kiro Hackathon, First Place) Jun 2026 - Present
Miro x Kiro Hackathon | New York, NY

- Won 1st place by defining the product experience for an AI-assisted medication-management tool serving people with dementia and caregivers.
- Designed the end-to-end interaction model (medication workflows, information hierarchy, navigation, error recovery) for a high-risk healthcare use case, translating accessibility and cognitive-load requirements into product decisions and a functional prototype.

UX Researcher & Product Designer, Cost of a Click (Interactive AI Impact Installation) Jul 2025 - Oct 2025
Chicago, IL | Winner, DePaul Summer Impact Grant 2025

- Ran 15 interviews and a 42-response survey, explored 3 concept directions and ran 2 rounds of usability testing to design an interactive experience that turns AI's environmental cost into real-time physical and on-screen feedback.
- Defined the end-to-end interaction from prompt to resource-use feedback, partnered with engineers to connect it in real time, and built the supporting product in Framer. In exit surveys (self-reported), 85% reported changed awareness of AI's environmental footprint and 73% intended to use AI more mindfully.

UX Researcher & UX Designer, Wellnut (VR Mental Wellness Prototype) Nov 2024 - May 2025
DePaul University | Chicago, IL

- Scoped a focused VR MVP from a student survey (about 70% saw value in VR meditation for exam stress) and a licensed-therapist consultation, choosing one end-to-end experience over five partial features.
- Designed the avatar companion experience (flows, dialogue, tone, session structure) and translated clinician input into safeguards including session limits, expectation-setting and escalation pathways; coordinated a cross-functional team and showcased the working prototype at the Jarvis Innovation Showcase (May 2025).

EDUCATION

MSc, Human-Computer Interaction - DePaul University, Chicago, Illinois, United States

MA, Design Management & Entrepreneurship - De Montfort University, Leicester, United Kingdom

Postgraduate Certificate, UX Design - Indian Institute of Technology Bombay, India

Bachelor of Design, Interior Design - Jawaharlal Nehru Architecture and Fine Arts University, Hyderabad, India

AWARDS & RESEARCH

Awards: Director's Award for Outstanding Researcher, RAISE Lab, DePaul University (2025-2026); Authorship Contribution Award, RAISE Lab, DePaul University (2025-2026); First Place, Miro x Kiro Hackathon (2026); Winner, DePaul Summer Impact Grant (2025); Outstanding Performance Award, HomeLane (2022).

Research: Co-author, "Making AI Infrastructure Visible: Interactive Art as a Public-Facing AI Ethics Interface," AIES 2026 (under review). "Consciously Assigning Personality to AI," CHI 2027 (in progress).